

GSoC 2026 Project Proposal

Matrix Product State Representations of Gaussian and Non-Gaussian Quantum States

Organization: Julia



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1 Introduction and Contributor Information

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2 Abstract

Simulating quantum many-body systems is a central challenge due to the exponential scaling of Hilbert space: for N particles with local dimension d , the full space dimension is d^N , rendering exact simulation intractable for $N \gtrsim 30$.

Matrix Product States (MPS) provide an efficient representation for low-entanglement states:

$$|\psi\rangle = \sum_{i_1, \dots, i_N} \sum_{\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_{N-1}} A_{1\alpha_1}^{[1]i_1} A_{\alpha_1\alpha_2}^{[2]i_2} \cdots A_{\alpha_{N-1}1}^{[N]i_N} |i_1, \dots, i_N\rangle,$$

with bond dimension $\chi = \max_k \chi_k$ giving $\mathcal{O}(Nd\chi^2)$ parameters—exponentially smaller than d^N .

While MPS methods are established for discrete-variable systems, extending them to **continuous-variable (CV) quantum systems** remains active. This project implements a unified framework for Gaussian and non-Gaussian CV states using MPS, building on Yanagimoto et al. (2021) [1] and Nüßeler et al. (2021) [2].

3 Mathematical Preliminaries

3.1 Continuous-Variable Systems

For a bosonic mode, quadrature operators $\hat{q} = (\hat{a} + \hat{a}^\dagger)/\sqrt{2}$, $\hat{p} = (\hat{a} - \hat{a}^\dagger)/(i\sqrt{2})$ satisfy $[\hat{q}, \hat{p}] = i$. Phase space is $\mathbb{R}^{2N}$ with symplectic form $\Omega = \bigoplus_{k=1}^N \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$.

3.2 Gaussian States

A Gaussian state has characteristic function $\chi(\xi) = \exp(-\frac{1}{4}\xi^\top \Omega \sigma \Omega^\top \xi + i\mathbf{d}^\top \Omega \xi)$, with displacement $\mathbf{d} = \langle \hat{\mathbf{r}} \rangle$ and covariance $\sigma_{ij} = \frac{1}{2}\langle \{\hat{r}_i, \hat{r}_j\} \rangle - \langle \hat{r}_i \rangle \langle \hat{r}_j \rangle$.

3.3 Bogoliubov Transformations

A Bogoliubov transformation T preserves CCR: $T\Omega T^\dagger = \Omega$. The Bloch-Messiah decomposition [2] gives $T = \bar{U}\bar{S}\bar{V}^\dagger$ with passive transformations $\bar{U}, \bar{V}$ and active squeezing $\bar{S} = \begin{pmatrix} \cosh \Theta & \sinh \Theta \\ \sinh \Theta & \cosh \Theta \end{pmatrix}$.

3.4 Supermode Demultiplexing [1]

For supermodes $\hat{A}^{(r)} = \sum_m f_m^{(r)} \hat{a}_m$, there exists unitary $\hat{V}$ (beam splitters + phase shifters) such that $\hat{V}^\dagger \hat{A}^{(r)} \hat{V} = \hat{a}_r$. Angles determined iteratively:

$$\theta_m^{(r)} = \arg(I_m), \quad \phi_m^{(r)} = \sin^{-1} |I_m|, \quad I_m = \frac{f_{m-r+1}^{(r)} - \sum_{k=r}^{m-1} g_k^{(r)} c_{k,m-r+1}^{(r-1)}}{c_{m,m-r+1}^{(r-1)} \prod_{k=r}^{m-1} \cos \phi_k^{(r)}}.$$

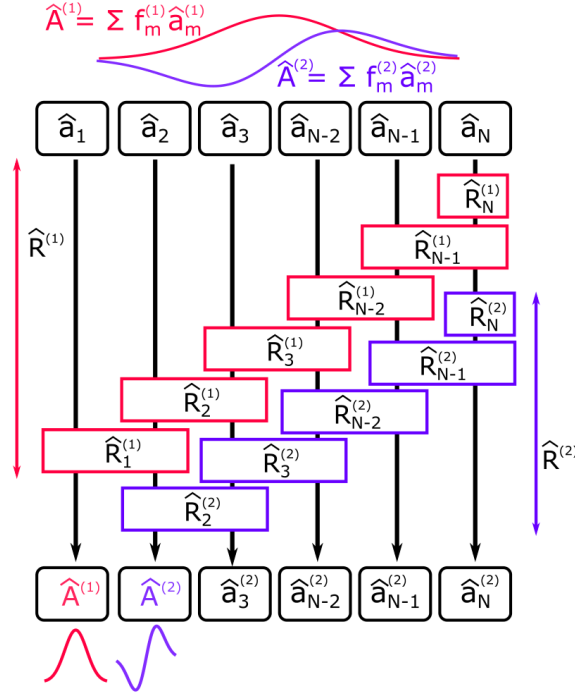


Figure 1: Illustration of the supermode demultiplexing scheme. Application of unitary transformation $\hat{R}^{(r)}$, composed of one-mode and two-mode gates $\{\hat{R}_r^{(r)}, \dots, \hat{R}_N^{(r)}\}$, demultiplexes the r th supermode $\hat{A}^{(r)} = \sum_m f_m^{(r)} \hat{a}_m$ to the r th (local) spatial bin. Operations up to $r = 2$ are shown, where local annihilation operators of the first and second bins are transformed to $\hat{A}^{(1)}$ and $\hat{A}^{(2)}$, respectively. Figure adapted from Yanagimoto et al. [1].

3.5 Wigner Negativity

Non-classicality measure: $\delta(\hat{\rho}) = \int d^{2N} \mathbf{r} (|W(\mathbf{r})| - W(\mathbf{r}))/2$.

4 Project Deliverables

4.1 Gaussian State MPS Construction

Implement Nüßeler et al. [2] algorithm:

1. Compute normal mode decomposition T s.t. $T^\dagger H T = D \oplus D$
2. Construct thermal MPO in normal modes: $\hat{\rho}_{\beta, \mathbf{b}} = \bigotimes_k (1 - e^{-2\beta d_k}) \sum_{n_k} e^{-2\beta d_k n_k} |n_k\rangle \langle n_k|$
3. Decompose $T = \bar{U} \bar{S} \bar{V}^\dagger$ via Bloch-Messiah
4. Implement passive transformations using Reck/Clements decomposition:
 $\bar{U} = \prod_m (\prod_k \hat{B}_k(\theta_{m,k}) \hat{P}_k(\phi_{m,k}))$

5. Implement active transformation: $\hat{S}(\theta_k) = \exp(\theta_k(\hat{a}_k^2 - \hat{a}_k^{\dagger 2}))$
6. Apply $\hat{U} = \bar{U}\bar{S}\bar{V}^\dagger$ via MPO-MPO multiplication

4.2 Supermode Demultiplexing

Implement Yanagimoto et al. [1]:

1. For $r = 1, \dots, s$, compute angles $\theta_m^{(r)}, \phi_m^{(r)}$ via iterative formula
2. Construct $\hat{R}^{(r)}$ from beam splitters and phase shifters
3. Apply $\hat{V}^{(s)}$ to MPS $|\Psi\rangle$ to obtain $|\Phi\rangle$
4. Extract reduced density matrix: $(\hat{\rho}_S)_{jj'} = \langle \Phi | (\bigotimes_{r=1}^s |j_r\rangle \langle j'_r| \otimes \bigotimes_{m=s+1}^N |m\rangle \langle m|) | \Phi \rangle$
5. Compute Wigner function: $W(\alpha) = \frac{2}{\pi} \text{Tr}[\hat{\rho}_S \hat{D}(\alpha)(-1)^{\hat{a}^\dagger \hat{a}} \hat{D}(-\alpha)]$

4.3 Time Evolution for Non-Gaussian States

Implement TEBD for Kerr nonlinearity:

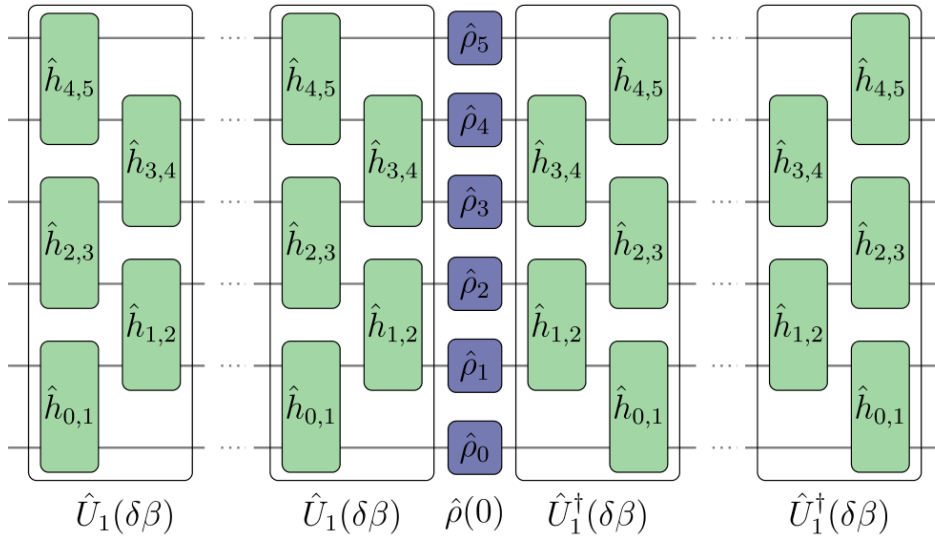


Figure 2: Tensor-network representation of density operator evolution via TEBD in imaginary time. The final state is obtained by successively applying the first-order propagator $\hat{U}_1(\delta\beta)$ to $\hat{\rho}$ from left and right. Each $\hat{U}_1(\delta\beta)$ consists of two layers comprising only two-site gates. For higher-order propagators, the number of layers increases. Figure adapted from Nüßeler et al. [2].

The Hamiltonian for a $\chi^{(3)}$ nonlinear waveguide is:

$$\hat{H} = -\frac{1}{2} \int dz (\hat{\phi}_z^\dagger \partial_z^2 \hat{\phi}_z + \hat{\phi}_z^{\dagger 2} \hat{\phi}_z^2)$$

TEBD implementation:

1. Trotterize: $\hat{U}(\delta t) \approx (\prod_{m \text{ odd}} \hat{D}_m)(\prod_{m \text{ even}} \hat{D}_m)(\prod_m \hat{S}_m)$
2. Apply gates sequentially, perform SVD truncation after each two-site gate
3. Compute observables: $\langle \hat{a}_m^\dagger \hat{a}_m \rangle, \text{Tr}(\hat{\rho}_S^2), \delta(\hat{\rho}_S)$

4.4 $\chi^{(2)}$ Hamiltonian Evolution

For $\chi^{(2)}$ nonlinear waveguides with fundamental harmonic (FH) and second harmonic (SH) modes:

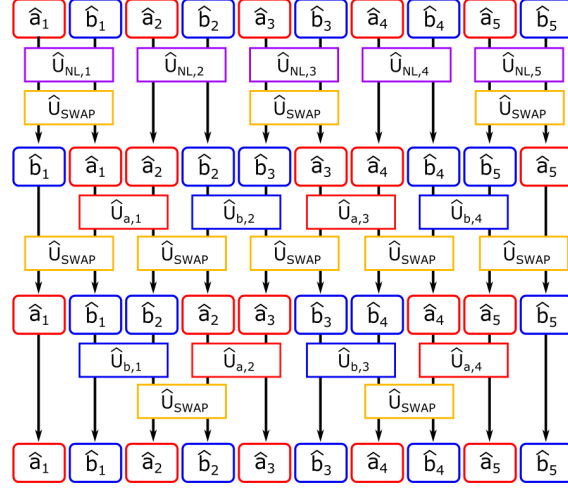


Figure 3: Discretized FH modes $\{\hat{a}_1, \dots, \hat{a}_N\}$ and SH modes $\{\hat{b}_1, \dots, \hat{b}_N\}$ are encoded on an MPS in alternating manner. Swap operations $\hat{U}_{SWAP}$ bring distant modes together. Two-mode operations $\hat{U}_{a,m}$, $\hat{U}_{b,m}$, and $\hat{U}_{NL,m}$ implement FH dispersion, SH dispersion, and nonlinear three-wave mixing, respectively. Figure adapted from Yanagimoto et al. [1].

The $\chi^{(2)}$ Hamiltonian takes the form:

$$\hat{H} = \int dz \left(\hat{\phi}_z^\dagger \partial_z^2 \hat{\phi}_z + \hat{\psi}_z^\dagger \partial_z^2 \hat{\psi}_z + \hat{\phi}_z^{\dagger 2} \hat{\psi}_z + \text{H.c.} \right)$$

4.5 Kerr Soliton Simulations

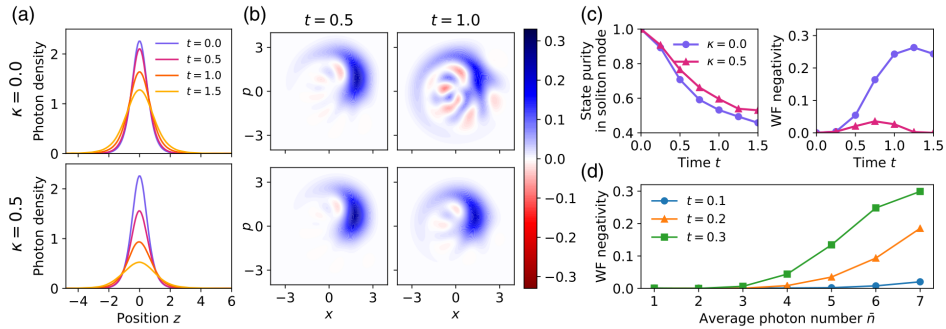


Figure 4: Quantum simulations of a pulse instantiated as a coherent-state sech soliton using MPS with bond dimension $\chi = 40$. Average photon number $\bar{n} = 3.0$ used with $(\kappa = 0.5)$ and without $(\kappa = 0)$ linear loss. MCWF with $M = 100$ quantum trajectories used for finite loss. (a) Time evolution of photon density distribution $\langle \hat{\phi}_z^\dagger \hat{\phi}_z \rangle$. (b) Wigner functions for reduced density matrix $\hat{\rho}_S$ for the sech supermode f^{sech} . Upper/lower rows: $\kappa = 0.0/0.5$. (c) Time evolution of purity $\text{Tr}(\hat{\rho}_S^2)$ (left) and doubled volume of Wigner function negativity (right). (d) WF negativity at various times as function of $\bar{n}$ with $\chi = 50$. Figure adapted from Yanagimoto et al. [1].

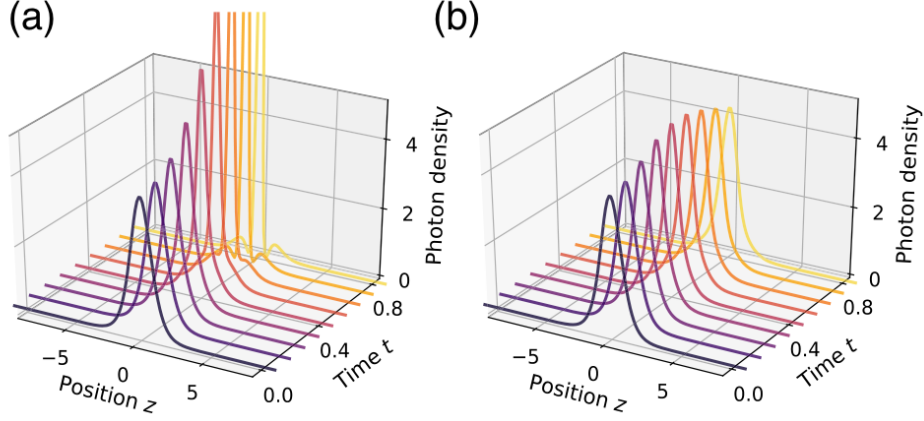


Figure 5: Time evolution of photon density distribution for a pulse instantiated as a coherent-state second-order soliton with mean photon number $\bar{n}^{(2\text{sech})} = 8$. (a) Classically expected dynamics. (b) Full quantum simulation under Hamiltonian Eq. (1) using MPS with bond dimension $\chi = 60$. Figure adapted from Yanagimoto et al. [1].

4.6 Benchmarking and Validation

- Compare with exact diagonalization for small systems ($N \leq 6$, $\chi \leq 20$)
- Reproduce Fig. 3 from Yanagimoto et al. (Wigner negativity for Kerr solitons)
 Reproduce Fig. 4 from Yanagimoto et al. (TDH comparison)
 Reproduce Fig. 5 from Yanagimoto et al. (second-order soliton dynamics)
 Reproduce Fig. 3 from Nüßeler et al. (floating-point operations scaling vs. temperature)

5 Timeline

Period	Activities
Community Bonding	Study MPS formalism, ITensors.jl API, CV quantum optics
Week 1-2	Literature review, environment setup, core tensor operations
Week 3-4	Implement Bloch-Messiah decomposition, Gaussian MPO construction
Week 5-6	Validate Gaussian MPO, implement benchmarks, reproduce Fig. 3 (Nüßeler)
Week 7-8	Implement supermode demultiplexing, Wigner function computation
Week 9-10	Implement TEBD for Kerr/ $\chi^{(2)}$, reproduce Figs. 3-7 (Yanagimoto)
Week 11-12	Benchmarking, optimization, documentation, final report

Table 1: Proposed timeline for GSoC 2026

6 Complexity Analysis

Operation	Complexity	Notes
Gaussian MPO construction	$\mathcal{O}(N^3 + N^2\chi^2d^2)$	N =modes, χ =bond dimension, d =cutoff
Supermode demultiplexing	$\mathcal{O}(sN^2\chi^2d^2)$	s =number of supermodes
TEBD time evolution	$\mathcal{O}(N\chi^3d^3)$	Per time step
$\chi^{(2)}$ evolution	$\mathcal{O}(N\chi^3d^3)$	With swap operations

Table 2: Computational complexity of key operations

7 Lessons from Previous GSoC Contributors

7.1 QuantumClifford.jl Contributions

Previous successful GSoC contributors have established patterns I will follow:

- **Maria (#78)**: Implemented error-correcting code infrastructure. Key lessons:
 - Environment management is critical (using `] dev` vs `] add`)
 - Regular `] status` and `git status` checks prevent path confusion
 - Breaking work into small, focused PRs simplifies review
- **Trung (#89)**: Added encoding circuits and syndrome measurement. Key lessons:
 - Use `Rational` types (e.g., `1//2`) instead of floating point for exact arithmetic
 - Test logical operations by encoding random states and comparing circuit vs. algebraic methods
 - General-purpose functions preferred over code-specific implementations
- **Roy Ess (#289,#298,#356)**: Implemented qLDPC codes and BP-OSD decoder. Key lessons:
 - Large features delivered as multiple merges
 - Documentation of "Current state" vs "Left to do" sets clear expectations
 - Breaking changes require coordinated PRs
- **Shayan Pardis (QuantumCliffordGPU.jl)**: GPU acceleration. Key lessons:
 - Performance benchmarks across varying n essential for validation
 - GPU porting requires careful attention to memory layout and kernel design

7.2 Application to This Proposal

These lessons directly inform my implementation strategy:

1. Use `Rational` for all angle calculations to avoid floating-point accumulation errors
2. Implement comprehensive tests: encoding random states, comparing algebraic vs. circuit methods
3. Provide GPU acceleration path using `CUDA.jl`

4. Document current state and remaining work at each milestone
5. Maintain environment isolation with separate Project.toml
6. Reproduce key figures from Yanagimoto & Nüßeler papers as validation

8 Past Experience

- **Quantum Inspired Active Learning for Materials Discovery** (NQComp 2026)
Wrote a paper on a quantum inspired active learning framework using amplitude encoding in Hilbert space and multi-observable uncertainty aggregation with non-commuting Hermitian operators for material science. Derived covariance aware acquisition functions modeling cross-property structure–property correlations. Across five independent trials and nine baselines (QBC, EI, BADGE, CoreSet, GP based methods), achieved 2.6–10.4% improvements in test R^2 and 25–35% reduction in sample complexity ($p < 0.01$). Complexity analysis shows scalable $O(NKd)$ performance under structured operators.
- **Lattice QCD and Critical Slowing Down**
Supervisor: Pablo Morande (University of Cambridge)
Implemented Hybrid Monte Carlo (HMC) and Metropolis–Hastings algorithms for lattice field simulations to analyze autocorrelation scaling and critical slowing through discretization of the harmonic oscillator.
- **Research Intern - JuliaSmoothOptimizers(JSO)**
Supervisor: Dominique Orban (Polytechnique Montreal)
Developing a structured pipeline to translate classical optimization problems into ADNLP-Models and JuMP formulations for integration into OptimizationProblems.jl.
- **Collaborator - TagBot**
Supervisor: Ian Butterworth
Working on building Julia TagBot further with currently 17 merged prs and 2 open prs. Role of TagBot is to create tags, releases, and changelogs for your Julia packages when they're registered
- **Bayesian Modeling – sktime**
Supervisor: Dr. Franz Kiraly (GCOS)
Working on implementing Bayesian probabilistic estimators within the skpro ecosystem. Developing posterior predictive models, integrating uncertainty quantification and proper scoring rules (e.g. log-score, CRPS).
- **LFX Mentee – Linux Kernel**
Contributed patches across filesystems(ext4, ntfs3, hpfs), memory management, and networking subsystems. Fixed use-after-free vulnerabilities and improved kernel build and error handling mechanisms.

8.1 Active Contributions to Gabs.jl

PR	Description	Status	Date
#94	No-Go Theorems section, Werner et al. (2001) reference	Merged	Jan 2026
#92	embed for GaussianUnitary, GaussianChannel, GaussianLinearCombination	Merged	Jan 2026
#91	Optional RNG arguments for deterministic testing	Merged	Jan 2026
#96	Heterodyne measurement interface	Open	Jan 2026
#104	Generalized GaussianLinearCombination to operators	Open	Mar 2026
#107	Quantum state tomography and performance docs	Open	Mar 2026

Table 3: Contributions to Gabs.jl

9 Commitment

I am completely free in the Summer and am prepared to give my full attention to the project.

In case of unavoidable circumstances leading to a temporary reduction in working hours, I will ensure to compensate for the time in the following weeks. I will communicate any such situations with my mentors well in advance to ensure smooth project progress.

For regular updates and discussions, I will be available via Teams, Zoom, and Google Meet in the Indian Standard Time Zone (GMT +5:30)

References

References

- [1] R. Yanagimoto, E. Ng, L. G. Wright, T. Onodera, and H. Mabuchi, “Efficient simulation of ultrafast quantum nonlinear optics with matrix product states,” *Optica*, vol. 8, no. 10, pp. 1306-1315, 2021.
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